needs to be unique per level in the hierarchy: two sibling actors can't have the same name (if you don't provide a name, Akka can generate one for you, but it's a good idea to name all your actors). All actor references can be located directly by an actor path, which can be absolute or relative.

1.7.2 ActorRef, mailboxes, and actors

Messages are sent to the actor's `ActorRef`. Every actor has a mailbox—it's a lot like a queue. Messages sent to the `ActorRef` are temporarily stored in the mailbox to be processed later, one at a time, in the order they arrived. Figure 1.21 shows the relationship between the `ActorRef`, the mailbox, and the actor. How the actor processes the messages is described in the next section.

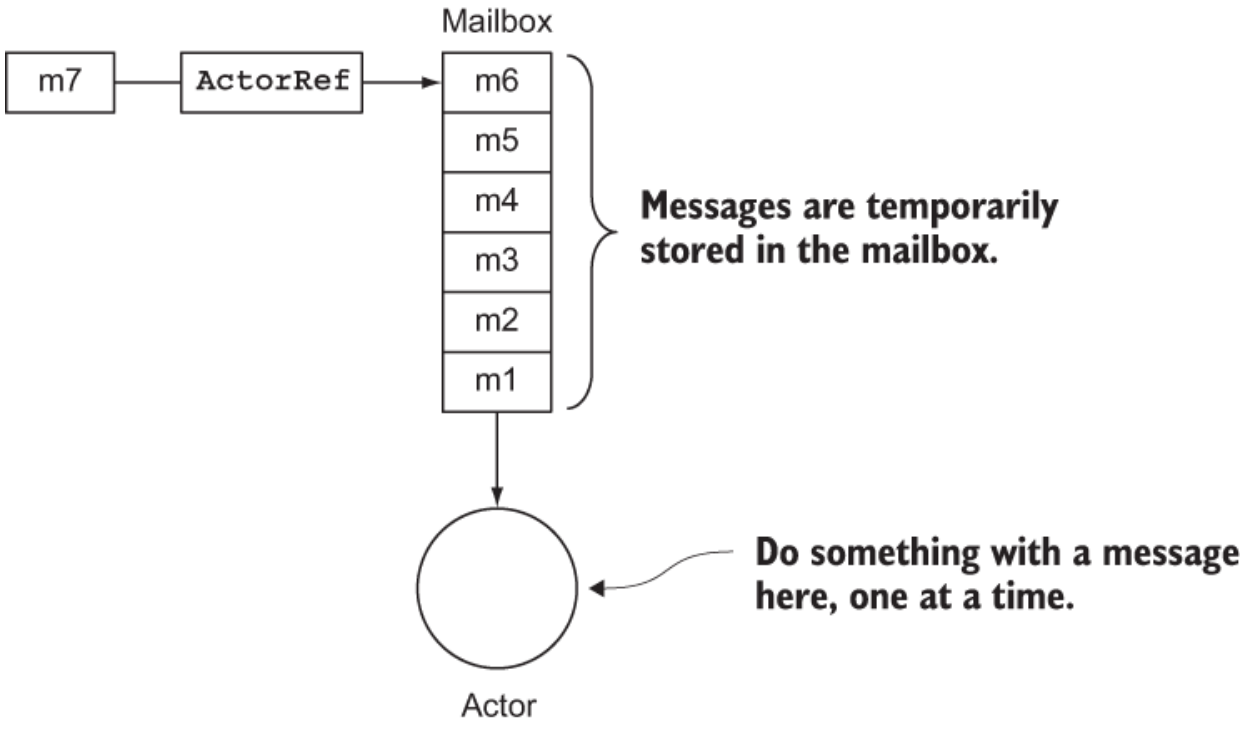


Figure 1.21 The `ActorRef`, a mailbox, and an actor